



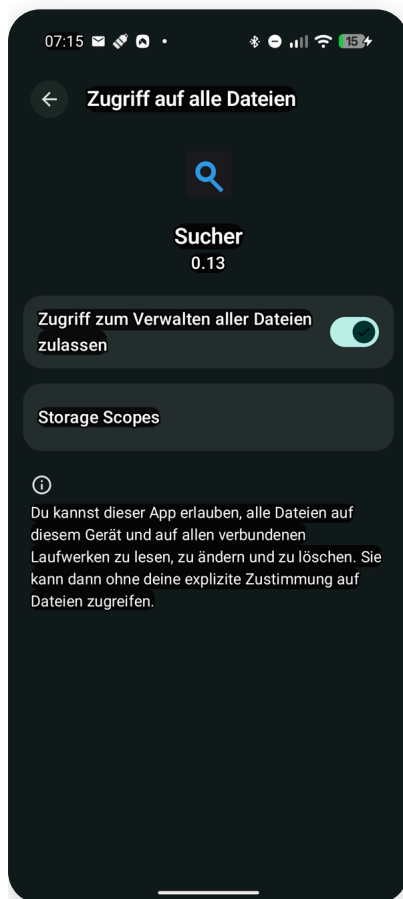
# Sucher — Guide

The full-device text search for Android, version 0.17

Sucher is a standalone, device-wide full-text search: file names and contents (text, Office, PDF, e-books, comic metadata), plus contacts, calendar entries, and captured notifications — all through one search box. Started in 2026 as a card inside EdgeTab, then split out because a search app needs a different permission profile and a different usage pattern (open, search, done — not a permanently running service). This guide walks through every feature once. Screenshots below are from the German-language build (Sucher does not currently offer an English UI — see the "About Sucher" section).

## 1 First launch: permissions

Sucher asks for nothing up front — each permission is offered only once the feature that needs it is actually used, via its own explanatory hint and button, never as a sudden system dialog.



**"Grant access" (All files):** required for file search at all. Opens Android's own "All files access" screen. If that screen doesn't exist on some devices/ROMs, Sucher automatically falls back to the app-info permissions page, where "All files" can be granted by hand just the same.

**"Allow contacts/calendar":** optional, only needed if contacts and calendar entries should be searchable too.

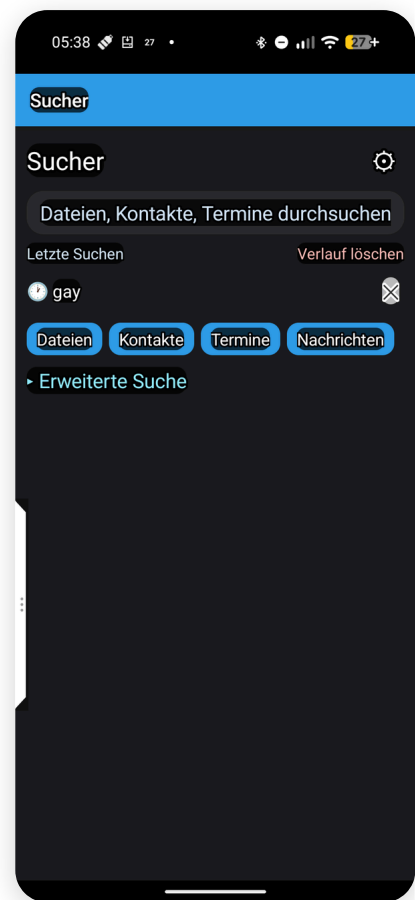
**"Grant notification access":** optional, for searching captured chat/mail notifications (see section 7). Worth knowing: this only captures what actually comes through as a notification — not a full message history.

Without at least the first permission and a chosen folder (section 6), file search stays empty.

## 2 Simple search

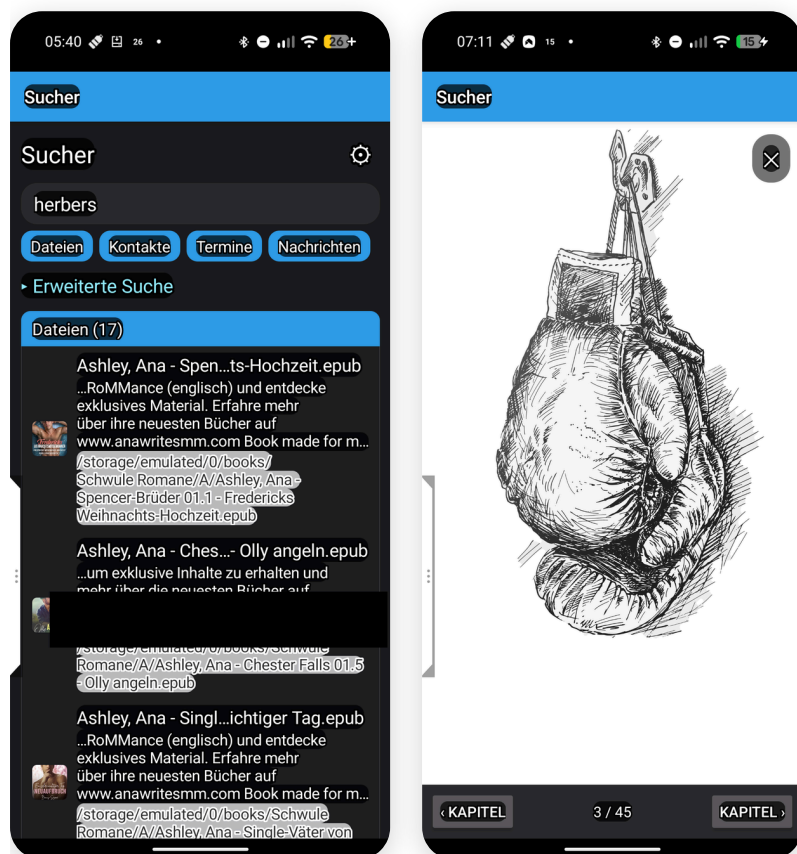
The search box on the home screen searches all four areas at once by default. The four category chips below it (Files, Contacts, Calendar, Messages) switch individual areas off when, say, only files should be searched.

**Search history:** the last 15 search terms appear under "Recent searches" while the search box is empty — tapping one repeats that search, the small X next to it removes a single entry, "Clear history" empties the whole list.



### 3 Opening a hit

Every hit shows a thumbnail where possible (book cover, first PDF page, image thumbnail, comic cover) and the full storage path. Tapping it opens a large preview with real page-flipping for images, PDFs and comics, plus a built-in reading view for EPUB and classic MOBI — tapping an entry in the table of contents jumps straight to that chapter without leaving the preview. Encrypted PDFs and DRM-protected e-books stay at just the file name, since Sucher deliberately does not bypass copy protection.



The email address in this example hit comes from the book file's own metadata text and was redacted for this guide. Right: the embedded reading view (here an EPUB) with the chapter bar at the bottom — "< Chapter" / "Chapter >" page through the book's chapter list.

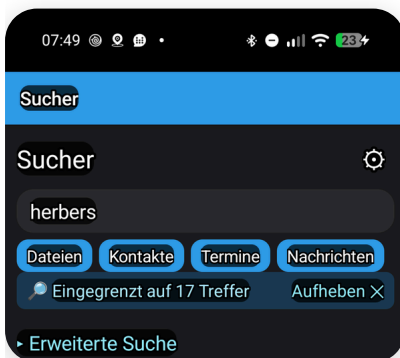
## 4 Advanced search



The category chips can still be toggled here too — in the example on the right, Contacts/ Calendar/Messages are active, Files deliberately deselected.

The "Advanced search" arrow unfolds extra, freely combinable fields: author, title, book series (from real e-book metadata, not just the file name), a multi-select file-type filter, plus date ranges for creation and modification date.

## 5 Narrowing down results



Below a file hit list, "Keep searching within these N hits" appears.

Tapping it restricts every following search to exactly this set of hits — even a completely different search: a new term in the simple search box, or a switch to advanced search with entirely different fields. That way a huge result set can be narrowed down step by step, instead of writing one single, giant combined search.

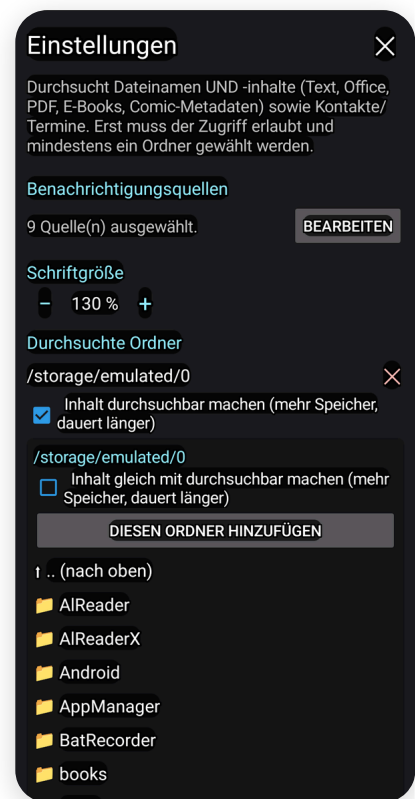
A blue banner "Narrowed to N hits" stays visible while the narrowing is active, and can be discarded any time via "Clear X". Narrowing can be repeated as often as needed — each new tap on "keep searching" replaces the previous narrowing with whatever hit set is currently visible.

## 6 Settings: folders, font size, sources

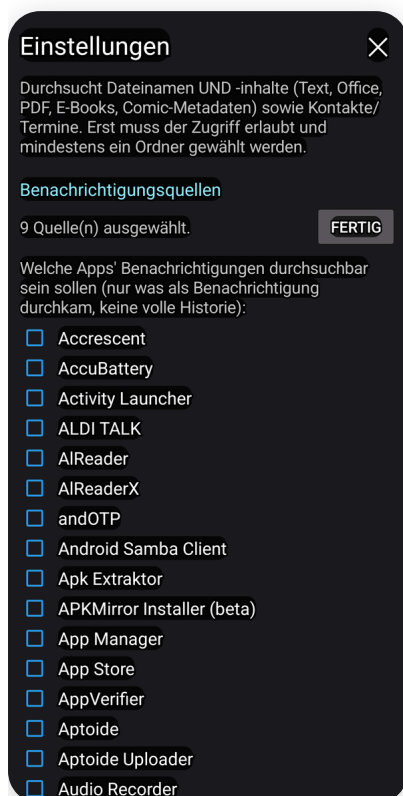
The gear icon top-right opens settings. Here you set which folders get searched, adjust the whole app's font size, and manage notification sources (see section 7).

Important — the difference between the two checkboxes: every folder is always indexed by name/type/date (cheap, fast). The extra "Make content searchable" checkbox additionally turns on full-text indexing for that specific folder — for a large e-book or document collection that can mean several gigabytes of index size, which is why it's per-folder and off by default.

The index catches up in the background via Android's JobScheduler in limited time windows, not as a permanent service — for very large libraries (tens of thousands of files) the first full pass can take several hours. Excluding the app from battery optimization (Android settings → Battery → Sucher → "Don't optimize") gets the background job noticeably more time windows and finishes markedly faster. A checkbox further down enables automatically refreshing the index every few hours.



## 7 Searching notifications too



"Edit notification sources" lets you decide per installed app whether its notifications get captured and made searchable — useful for chat and mail apps. This requires notification access once (section 1); afterwards every new notification from the selected apps lands in the index automatically.

No access to message history from before granting access, and no full chat history — only what actually comes through as a notification while Sucher is running.

## 8 About Sucher

Right at the bottom of settings sits "About Sucher": version number, license text, and a collapsible changelog right inside the app. Sucher is under the GNU General Public License v3; bundled third-party libraries (Apache POI, PDFBox-Android, Apache Commons, Log4j API, SparseBitSet, curvesapi) remain under their own, compatible license (Apache 2.0 resp. BSD-3-Clause) — details are in the LICENSE file in the source code.

### Source code & download

Full source code, build instructions and a ready-made APK: [github.com/8818freak/Sucher](https://github.com/8818freak/Sucher). No Gradle, no hidden dependencies, no account needed. Feedback and ideas are welcome.